

Supplemental Materials

Here, we report additional details and results that were omitted from the main text for the sake of brevity.

List of Targets

Study 1 targets: Dog, cat, horse, rabbit, cow, pig, chicken, goat, sheep, shrimp, fish, bee, wasp, ant, fly, octopus, frog, worm, pigeon, owl, whale, shark, wolf, snake, rat, spider, mouse, lion, chimpanzee, elephant.

Study 2 targets: Dog, cat, horse, rabbit, cow, pig, chicken, goat, sheep, shrimp, fish, bee, wasp, ant, fly, octopus, frog, worm, pigeon, owl, whale, shark, wolf, snake, rat, spider, mouse, lion, chimpanzee, elephant, a family member, a close friend, your partner/spouse, a citizen of the country you live in, somebody from your neighborhood, a co-worker, a foreign citizen, a member of the political party you oppose, somebody with different religious beliefs, the head of state of the country you live in, a soldier of the country you live in, a charity worker, a homosexual person, a mentally challenged person, a refugee, a murderer, a terrorist, a child molester, a redwood tree, an apple tree, a rose bush, a coral reef, old-growth forest, the highest mountain in the country you live in.

Additional Analyses

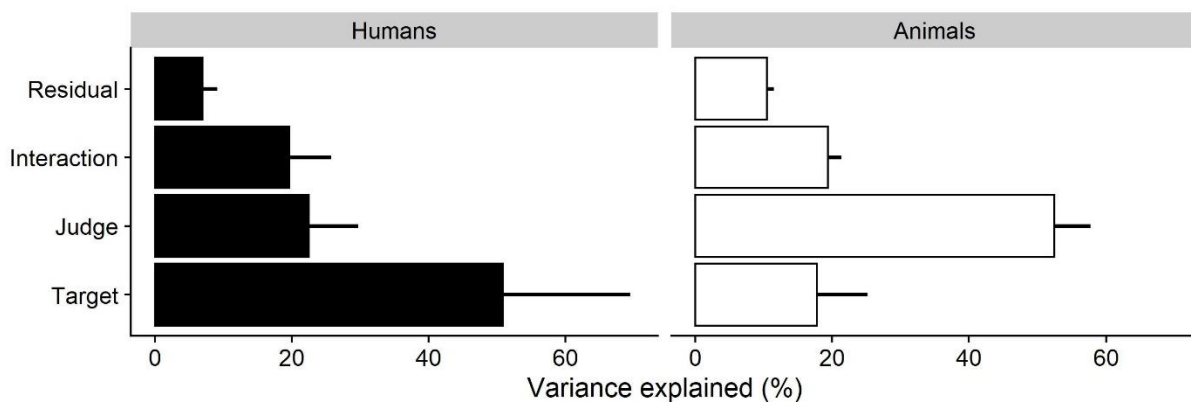
Human vs. Non-Human Targets

We explored whether the variance components of moral concern differed across different groups of targets. We estimated the variance components separately for human and animal targets (see Figure S1). Results showed that between-target differences explained more variance when judging human targets (50.88%, 95% CI [35.70%, 69.44%]) than when judging animal targets (17.77%, 95% CI [10.81%, 25.21%]). Conversely, between-judge differences explained

more variance when judging animal targets (52.44%, 95% CI [47.04%, 57.76%]) than when judging human targets (22.52%, 95% CI [13.74%, 29.73%]). One explanation for this pattern of results is that participants showed strong consensus on the moral standing of certain human targets (see Figure 4). Family and friends were rated as maximally worthy of moral concern by many participants (partner/spouse: 77.80%, family members: 66.61%, close friends: 59.04%), whereas villains were rated as minimally worthy of moral concern by many participants (child molesters: 56.28%, terrorists: 49.05%, murderers: 39.24%). By comparison, consensus on the moral standing of animals was relatively lower.

Figure S1

Relative contributions of target characteristics, judge characteristics, and the interaction between judge and target characteristics in explaining variation in judgments of moral concern when analyzing only human targets or only animal targets



Note. Error bars represent 95% confidence intervals.

Cross-Country Differences

To explore whether culture-specific relationships influenced participants' judgments of moral concern, we examined cross-country differences in ratings of rabbits and coral reefs.

Australian participants showed lower moral concern for rabbits ($M = 5.18$, $SD = 2.28$) compared to participants from the United States ($M = 5.64$, $SD = 2.32$; $t(382.9) = 2.03$, $p = .043$, $d = -0.21$, 95% CI [-0.41, -0.01]) and the United Kingdom ($M = 5.62$, $SD = 2.21$; $t(386.5) = 1.99$, $p = .047$, $d = -0.201$, 95% CI [-0.401, -0.002]). This may be explained by the fact that rabbits are more disruptive to human activities and are more commonly viewed as pests in Australia. Conversely, Australian participants showed greater moral concern for coral reefs ($M = 6.33$, $SD = 2.35$), which are a central feature of Australia's natural heritage, compared to participants from the United States ($M = 5.59$, $SD = 2.58$; $t(378.2) = 3.07$, $p = .002$, $d = 0.31$, 95% CI [0.11, 0.51]). Differences in moral concern for coral reefs between participants from Australia and the United Kingdom were not significant ($M = 6.34$, $SD = 2.20$; $t(386.9) = 0.01$, $p = .99$, $d = -0.001$, 95% CI [-0.200, 0.198]).

Additional Measures

In both studies, additional data was collected. These measures were not included as additional exploratory measures for the present study, but as part of a separate study on people's willingness to reduce meat consumption (see Cameron et al., 2023). Specifically, after completing the two sets of moral concern ratings, participants indicated how willing they would be to cut different amounts of meat from their diet for a week. Participants also reported their diet and how many meals that they eat in a typical week contain meat.

References

- Cameron, S., Wilks, M., & Jaeger, B. (2023). Reduce by how much? Calibrating meat reduction appeals to maximize their effectiveness. *Psychology of Human-Animal Intergroup Relations*, 2, e9511. <https://doi.org/10.5964/phair.9511>